

**Current Affairs • 1 October 2026****14 min**  
READING TIME**8**  
KEY STORIES**30**  
IN BRIEF**1**  
MCQS + MAINS

GS1 • 4 GS2 • 24

GS3 • 32

PAPER MIX

01 – TODAY IN 2 MINUTES

**The 5 stories you can't skip**

- Households without biometric Aadhaar authentication to receive only 5kg or 10kg cylinders**  
**Why it matters:** The Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas mandated that households lacking biometric Aadhaar authentication (BAA) will only receive 5kg or 10kg...  
GS3 • ECONOMY P M
- 80% of Mumbaikars refuse 0.4% MDR on UPI payments above ₹2,000**  
**Why it matters:** The Ministry of Finance notified a framework to introduce a 0.4% Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI payments above ₹2,000, sparking consumer resista...  
GS3 • ECONOMY P M
- India's economy faces risks as crude oil prices jump 28.66% to \$116.04**  
**Why it matters:** The Finance Ministry flagged risks to India's economy due to a 28.66% surge in crude oil prices in September and potential US-led trade restrictions...  
GS3 • ECONOMY P M
- Supreme Court rules out nationwide firecracker ban, accepts limited relaxation for green crackers**  
**Why it matters:** The Supreme Court rejected a blanket ban on firecrackers, opting for a conditional relaxation based on CSIR-NEERI's recommendations for 'green cracke...  
GS3 • ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY P M
- Piyush Goyal meets Jamieson Greer to discuss interim trade agreement amid US tariff changes**  
**Why it matters:** Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal met U.S.  
GS2 • INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS P M

P.2 KEY STORIES » IN BRIEF + PLACES » TEST YOURSELF

P = PRELIMS • M = MAINS

# What to know, in 60 seconds each

8 of 60 notes · picked for exam value

GS3 · ECONOMY

P

M

## Households without biometric Aadhaar authentication to receive only 5kg or 10kg cylinders

**Why in news:** The Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas mandated that households lacking biometric Aadhaar authentication (BAA) will only receive 5kg or 10kg cylinders at market prices to ensure subsidy integrity.

### REMEMBER

- Indian Oil, BPCL, and HPCL are the three major public sector oil marketing companies in India.
- The mandate restricts households without BAA to 5kg or 10kg cylinders at market prices.
- The Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas oversees the distribution of LPG subsidies.

**MAINS ANGLE** Discuss how the integration of biometric authentication in Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) schemes balances the objective of subsidy leakage prevention with the challenge of digital exclusion.

USE: Direct Benefit Transfer Digital Exclusion

Subsidy Leakage eKYC

Full note → [satyadheesh.in/news/129190](https://satyadheesh.in/news/129190)

GS3 · ECONOMY

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## India's economy faces risks as crude oil prices jump 28.66% to \$116.04

**Why in news:** The Finance Ministry flagged risks to India's economy due to a 28.66% surge in crude oil prices in September and potential US-led trade restrictions on Russian crude.

### REMEMBER

- India's crude oil basket price in September: \$116.04 per barrel
- Real GDP growth rate in Q1 FY27: 7.8%
- Indian crude basket composition: Sweet crude (Brent-based) and Sour crude (Oman and Dubai grades)

**MAINS ANGLE** Analyze how volatile global energy prices and geopolitical trade shifts impact India's fiscal stability and domestic inflation targets.

USE: Imported Inflation Energy Security Fiscal Risk

Trade Volatility

Full note → [satyadheesh.in/news/128822](https://satyadheesh.in/news/128822)

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## 80% of Mumbaikars refuse 0.4% MDR on UPI payments above ₹2,000

**Why in news:** The Ministry of Finance notified a framework to introduce a 0.4% Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI payments above ₹2,000, sparking consumer resistance and merchant pushback.

### REMEMBER

- MDR of 0.4% applies to person-to-merchant (P2M) UPI payments above ₹2,000 starting October 15, 2026
- MDR is capped at ₹300 per transaction for payments of ₹75,000 and above
- Maharashtra accounted for 9.84% of UPI transactions by volume as of April 2026

**MAINS ANGLE** Discuss the economic implications of transitioning from a zero-MDR model to a fee-based structure for UPI payments on the digital economy and financial inclusion.

USE: Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) Digital Payments

Financial Inclusion Transaction Costs

Full note → [satyadheesh.in/news/128866](https://satyadheesh.in/news/128866)

GS3 · ENVIRONMENT &amp; ECOLOGY

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## Supreme Court rules out nationwide firecracker ban, accepts limited relaxation for green crackers

**Why in news:** The Supreme Court rejected a blanket ban on firecrackers, opting for a conditional relaxation based on CSIR-NEERI's recommendations for 'green crackers' to balance cultural practices with air quality.

### REMEMBER

- CSIR-NEERI: Council of Scientific and Industrial Research – National Environmental Engineering Research Institute
- PESO: Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation regulates the manufacture and storage of explosives
- Gen-2 green crackers reduce PM10 and PM2.5 pollution by 45%–60% compared to traditional crackers

**MAINS ANGLE** Discuss the conflict between individual cultural rights and the collective right to a clean environment in the context of air pollution management in urban India.

USE: Precautionary Principle Right to Clean Environment

Regulatory Compliance Pollution Mitigation

Full note → [satyadheesh.in/news/128805](https://satyadheesh.in/news/128805)

## Piyush Goyal meets Jamieson Greer to discuss interim trade agreement amid US tariff changes

**Why in news:** Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal met U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer to negotiate an interim trade agreement amidst shifting U.S. tariff policies.

### REMEMBER

- Jamieson Greer: U.S. Trade Representative (USTR)
- Meeting date: September 30, 2026
- India's trade competitors in this context: ASEAN, China, and Bangladesh

**MAINS ANGLE** Analyze the challenges India faces in securing favorable trade terms with the United States amidst fluctuating global tariff regimes and regional competition.

USE : Trade Liberalization Tariff Protectionism  
Bilateral Cooperation Trade Diplomacy

Full note → [satyadheesh.in/news/128774](https://satyadheesh.in/news/128774)

## India proposes \$25 billion pool to support Deep Tech startups and reduce foreign dependence

**Why in news:** India proposed a \$25 billion fund to support Deep Tech startups to reduce reliance on foreign technology, as highlighted by the IVCA-Venture Intelligence Bharat DeepTech Report 2026.

### REMEMBER

- Proposed Deep Tech fund size: \$25 billion
- IVCA: Indian Venture and Alternate Capital Association
- Total funding recorded between 2015 and July 2026: \$11.4 billion

**MAINS ANGLE** Discuss how fostering a robust Deep Tech ecosystem can enhance India's technological sovereignty and reduce its dependence on foreign intellectual property.

USE : Technological Sovereignty Deep Tech Venture Capital  
Capital Formation

Full note → [satyadheesh.in/news/128688](https://satyadheesh.in/news/128688)

## India's external debt rose \$15.4 billion to \$778.2 billion by end-June

**Why in news:** RBI data revealed a rise in India's external debt to \$778.2 billion by June 2024, reflecting the country's evolving debt-to-GDP dynamics.

### REMEMBER

- India's total external debt reached \$778.2 billion by June 2024.
- India's debt-to-GDP ratio moderated to 20.8% as of June 2024.
- August 2024 services trade exports were \$35.5 billion against \$18.9 billion imports.

**MAINS ANGLE** Analyze the factors influencing India's external debt dynamics and discuss the implications of a moderating debt-to-GDP ratio on India's macroeconomic stability.

USE : Debt-to-GDP ratio External debt  
Macroeconomic stability Current account

Full note → [satyadheesh.in/news/128726](https://satyadheesh.in/news/128726)

## Russia warns NATO it will use entire arsenal including nuclear weapons over Kaliningrad blockade

**Why in news:** Russia issued a diplomatic memo to NATO threatening the use of its entire arsenal, including nuclear weapons, in response to potential blockades of the Kaliningrad exclave.

### REMEMBER

- Kaliningrad: A Russian exclave located on the Baltic Sea, bordering Poland and Lithuania.
- Mark Rutte: The current Secretary-General of NATO.
- Russia's nuclear arsenal is the largest in the world, governed by various arms control treaties.

**MAINS ANGLE** Analyze the implications of the escalating Russia-NATO tensions in the Baltic region on European security architecture and global nuclear non-proliferation norms.

USE : Nuclear Deterrence Exclave Collective Defense  
Geopolitical Friction

Full note → [satyadheesh.in/news/128679](https://satyadheesh.in/news/128679)

# Everything else, one line each

30 more notes · full versions online

## GS1 · HISTORY · SOCIETY · GEOGRAPHY

Karnataka faces -32% rainfall deficit as Bengaluru South sees -87% shortage

Northeast monsoon likely normal after 20% Southwest monsoon deficit, IMD Director-General says

## GS2 · POLITY · GOVERNANCE · SOCIAL JUSTICE · IR

Narendra Modi and Donald Trump had a productive telephone call reviewing bilateral ties, trade

Trump signs White House Accord on Super Intelligence with Meta, Nvidia, and Google

ECI extends Andhra Pradesh house-to-house enumeration until July 24, 2026

Netherlands Minister Silvio Erkens visits Bengaluru to explore agricultural collaboration with 18 businesses

Court orders blocking services for motorists with ₹49,194.05 crore outstanding e-challans

KSTDC and Muzrai Department sign 10-year agreement to manage Tirumala Tourist Complex

AP HRD Minister orders DSC 2.0 notification and 'Zero Dropout Mission' within a month

Kumaraswamy requests Srirangapatna tourism hub development under Swadesh Darshan 2.0 scheme

Andhra Pradesh High Court sets aside BC reservations exceeding 50% threshold in local bodies

MSF warns \$28,000 annual cost limits access to Gilead's HIV prevention injection

Karnataka demands price controls after FSDA finds drugs marked up 52.6 times cost

Class 9 students to learn income tax liability in new NCERT social science book

Keralam to draft Bill for Tribal University in Wayanad with ₹50 crore budget

Telangana directs DEOs to conduct pilot external evaluations for Classes 6 and 9

Modi says UPSC exams must test why youth want public service over office

Union Ministry of Tourism sanctions ₹55.74 crore for Arasavalli Sun God temple development

## GS3 · ECONOMY · S&T · ENVIRONMENT · SECURITY

Revanth Reddy cabinet approves ₹2,500 crore annual Dearness Allowance installments

Thrissur forest office stops PCK from using 4,261 hectares of lease-expired land

11 start-ups to receive up to ₹50 lakh for climate-resilient healthcare and agriculture

National PNG Drive 3.0 targets 50 lakh new connections and 40 lakh conversions

Naidu, Chouhan to launch 3D Concrete Printing project for 177 houses in Guntur

Madras High Court orders Tamil Nadu to create SOP for elephants in religious festivals

Naidu, Sitharaman and Pawan Kalyan to launch ₹1 lakh-crore Global Horticulture Hub

TGNPDCL crosses 100 MW solar capacity under PM-KUSUM-A scheme for farmers' income

Civil Aviation Ministry approves full-body scanners for 8 major Indian airports

Adani Green to build world's largest single-location battery storage at Khavda, Gujarat

Supreme Court sets aside Sambhal detention order, imposes ₹10 lakh costs on State

Telangana to launch common metro and bus pass on October 2, 2026

## Write one answer today

GS3 · ECONOMY

**Discuss how the integration of biometric authentication in Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) schemes balances the objective of subsidy leakage prevention with the challenge of digital exclusion.**

USE : [Direct Benefit Transfer](#) [Digital Exclusion](#) [Subsidy Leakage](#) [eKYC](#) [Public Distribution System](#)



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